

# **Inclusive Supports in Education**

**DAY 6**

**Instructor: Leonie Stephens**



# Agenda

- Transitions: Kindergarten
  - Early learning programs
  - Support kindergarten transition at home
  - Students with special needs
- Transition :Adulthood
  - Role of the School
  - Transition planning
  - Community Services / STADD Navigator

# Roles of Key Staff

## **Learning Support Teacher or Resource Teacher:**

Works with the Classroom Teacher to develop the student's IEP

- Consults with the parents in the development of the IEP.
- Consults with the classroom teacher on all matters related to the IEP
- Provides service to students in the classroom, small groups and individual settings as appropriate
- With the classroom teacher oversees the work of the Education Assistants

# Roles of Key Staff

## **School Counsellor:**

- Provides group and/or classroom-based services which may include prevention programs (e.g. child abuse prevention, substance abuse awareness, safety programs etc.)
- Individual based services may include support to students with issues that are affecting their social-emotional well-being. An example may include helping a student through challenging peer relations or conflict situations.
- Work with the school team to support students with transitions; e.g. Kindergarten, Middle School, High School.
- In the case of high school counsellors, advice and assistance with the selection of courses leading to a successful transition to post-secondary settings.

# Roles of Key Staff

## Classroom Teacher:

- Designs the instruction program and plans learning activities.
  - Determines (in consultation with the Learning Support Teacher) the adaptations or modifications required as outlined in the IEP.
  - Instructs, supervises and facilitates student learning.
  - Ensures assessment and learner profiles are current.
  - Reports to parents through both informal and formal written reports.
- Roles and Responsibilities of Teachers, Teacher Assistants and Education Assistants (2009)

# Roles of Key Staff

## **Education Assistant:**

- Shares relevant information about the performance and behaviour of individual students to support the implementation of the IEP.
- Gathers relevant information through working with students to provide feedback for the (IEP) planning process.
- Produces materials and implements strategies (as outlined in the IEP).
- Facilitates student learning individually and in small groups (as instructed by the teacher).
- Assists in the collection of data for the purpose of evaluating student progress.
- Provides information to the teacher for home/school communication.

Roles and Responsibilities of Teachers, Teacher Assistants and Education Assistants (2009)

# Roles of Key Staff:

## District Learning Services Support Team

- **District Physical Therapist:** offers services to students with orthopedic, neurological, muscular, spinal, joint or sensory dysfunction
- **District Occupational Therapist:** provides services to students with orthopedic, neurological, muscular, spinal, joint or sensory dysfunction as well as those with cognitive and complex neuro-behavioural conditions
- **District School Psychologists:** provide formal educational assessment services.
- **District Speech-Language Pathologists:** support to students who have communication difficulties.
- **District Vision Teacher:** provides support to students who are visually impaired.

# Roles of Key Staff

## **Child & Youth Care Worker:**

- Provides support to students individually or in small group settings inside and outside the classroom throughout the day.
- They work to support students in attaining social-emotional and/or behavioural goals in students' IEPs.
- Most often, Child & Youth Care Workers are assigned to support students designated in Category H: *Intensive Behaviour Interventions/ Serious Mental Illness* and Category R: *Moderated Behaviour Intervention/ Mental Illness*.



# Aboriginal Support Worker/Indigenous Education Worker

- Provides support to students who have self-identified as Aboriginal.
- Support is provided individually or in small group settings inside and outside the classroom throughout the day.
- There are three areas of support:
  - Academic
  - Social-Emotional
  - Cultural
- An Aboriginal Support Worker is assigned for each school. The number of days a week depends on the number of Aboriginal students are enrolled in the school.

# Roles of Key Staff

## **Settlement Worker in Schools (SWIS):**

- Helps newcomer students and their families adapt and integrate into Canadian life during their initial years in Canada.
- Settlement Works in Schools a contract provided by MOSAIC in our schools.
- MOSAIC provides newcomer students and their families with free assistance located in our schools in addition to field trips and workshops.
- SWIS workers are multilingual and are experienced in helping students and families adjust to education in Canada as well as integrating into the community.
- The goal of the SWIS program is to help new families feel welcome and fully engaged within their new community.
- There is a SWIS worker assigned to each school in our district.

# English Language Learners

- English Language Learners or ELL can also receive support from the LST/ELL teacher and, **IF** resources allow, an EA.
- ELL learners have to meet an eligibility requirement to receive additional support from an ELL or LST teacher.
  - An annual assessment of the student's level of English
  - Annual Instructional Plan (AIP) is developed
  - Specialized supplementary ELL services
  - Progress report to parents about student's progress in English Language acquisition
  - An ELL specialist is involved in planning and delivering services

# English Language Learners

Push/Pull Factors that Impact Students & Families:

- **Pull Factors** – what pulls people toward a new place:
  - opportunity, freedom, family unification, educational opportunities, health care availability, housing, etc.
- **Push Factors** – what pushes people to leave their homes:
  - poverty, oppression, persecution, lack of needed health care
- The general consensus is that it takes between five to seven years for an individual to achieve advanced fluency. If the ELL does not come with fully developed first language and literacy skills, it may take seven to ten years to reach advanced fluency.

# English Language Learners

There are four phases that immigrants and English Language Learners go through while getting used to a new language and adapting to the mainstream culture:

- *Honeymoon Phase* – exhilaration, hopefulness
- *Culture Shock Phase* – confusion, discouragement
- *Adjustment Phase* – understanding of new culture, acceptance of differences; balancing and blending native and new
- *Acceptance Phase* – identification with new culture

# English Language Learners - Goal

ELL services should enable students to become competent in social and academic communication, in order to:

- Achieve the expected learning outcomes of the provincial curriculum;
- Develop their individual potential; and
- Acquire the language proficiency, skills, and learning strategies and interpersonal skills needed to succeed in school and contribute positively to society.

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# English Language Learners – Supporting Learning

- The class is going to be divided into 5 groups and will be assigned one page from the document *Planning and Strategies to Support English Language Learners*
- Your job is to read your assigned page and decide:
  - What strategies are universal strategies (good for all students)
  - What strategies are good for tier 2 and tier 3 students
  - What strategies only apply to ELL learners
  - What strategies can you support?



# Transitions



# Transition to Kindergarten

- A full day, play-based kindergarten program has long-term benefits for a child's academic and social skills – it can help them succeed in school and in life.
- Children can start kindergarten in September of the year they turn five years old.
- Kindergarten registration usually begins in January or February for the following September. Parents/caregivers should contact their local school district or independent school authority for registration information.
- Kindergarten can be an adjustment period for both the child and the family

# Support the Transition to Kindergarten

## Early Learning Program: StrongStart

- There are a number of programs designed to support your child's early learning.

**1) StrongStart** BC centres are a drop-in program intended for both children (0-5) and caregivers to engage in play-based learning activities.

- StrongStart BC programs provide rich learning environments designed for early learning development – language, physical, cognitive, social and emotional. Qualified early childhood educators lead learning activities where children find opportunities to make friends and interact with others of similar ages.

# Support the Transition to Kindergarten Early Learning Program:

**2) Ready/Set/Learn :** Intended for families and their three- to five-year-old children, Ready, Set, Learn is all about fostering positive connections between families, the school system and local community agencies. Elementary schools that enroll Kindergarten classes hold Ready, Set, Learn events in their schools or communities. These events provide a fun, family-oriented atmosphere with the intent of supporting children's transitions into school.

- **Toolkit topics:** Talking, Books, Numbers, Feelings, Getting along with others, The wider world, Play, TV & electronic media, Vision & hearing, Physical activity / Healthy snacks

# Support Kindergarten Transition at Home

- When I Go to Kindergarten is a booklet put together by the ministry to prepare both parents & children for the transition.
- 1) **Well-being and belonging** – an important sense that can be developed and fostered through responsive and reciprocal relationships with people and places – immediate environment, communities and culture – My Story /Drawing of me & my family.
  - 2) **My interactions with the world around me** – Through having different experiences with different people, places, nature and items. Adults to inspire and attend to children's interest to foster curiosity & learning. World around me

# Support Kindergarten Transition at Home

**3) My ways of communicating** – Learning through observing, imitating and listening to their parents. Learning how to express, explore and connect their thoughts, feelings and imagination through talking, story-telling, drawing, playing, etc. The ways we connect.

**4) My sense of who I am** – The more children are taught about who they are and where they come from, the more they learn to move with confidence among a diversity of communities. Helping children to become active members while developing understanding on how to make the world a better place.

# Support Kindergarten Transition at Home

- Extended engagement in play is one of the best ways to prepare your child for school.
- Children's play experiences have a profound impact on all areas of their growth, learning, and development.

## Types of Adult Approaches to Play



# Ready for Kindergarten!



## I'm ready for school when...

### Health and Well-Being

- ☐ I am healthy and my immunizations are up to date.
- ☐ I have good oral health and have visited my dentist.
- ☐ I am well-rested.
- ☐ I can fasten my pants and put on my jacket.
- ☐ I can kick balls, hop on one foot and climb the ladder at the park.
- ☐ I can eat, wash my hands, blow my nose and use the toilet by myself.
- ☐ I get at least 60 minutes a day of exercise and active play.

### Social and Emotional Development

- ☐ I take turns, share and help others.
- ☐ I stay focused and pay attention for 10-15 minutes at a time.
- ☐ I can keep trying, even when I don't know how to do something.
- ☐ I enjoy following the rules and helping to make the rules.
- ☐ I can work and play both independently and in a group.
- ☐ I can manage my behavior with help.
- ☐ I can calm myself down when I get frustrated.

### Language & Communication Skills

- ☐ I hear and understand the meaning of words, stories and songs.
- ☐ I use words to talk about thoughts, wants, needs and feelings.
- ☐ I speak clearly enough that other people understand.
- ☐ I use complete sentences and connect ideas to make longer sentences.
- ☐ I can say or sing familiar songs and nursery rhymes.
- ☐ I follow one- and two-step directions such as, "Please pick up your plate and put it in the sink."

### Early Literacy

- ☐ I enjoy books and stories.
- ☐ I can use a crayon or pencil.
- ☐ I know how to use a book: from start to finish and how to turn pages.
- ☐ I know some of the letters of the alphabet.
- ☐ I can write some of the letters in my first name.
- ☐ I know rhyming words like pat, hat, cat and bat.

### Mathematical Thinking

- ☐ I can count 10 items correctly.
- ☐ I know primary colors and shapes - red, blue and yellow; circle, square and triangle.
- ☐ I can sort silverware into spoons, knives and forks.
- ☐ I can put together a puzzle through trial and error.
- ☐ I can sort beads on a necklace in a color pattern.
- ☐ I can organize four objects from smallest to largest.

**All children grow and develop at their own pace.**

Use this checklist to identify the skills you can help your child develop in order to prepare them for lifelong learning.



# Kindergarten Transition Planning/Timeline for Special Needs Students

- **October-December:** Gather information such as previous reports, therapists and other professionals involved with the child.
  - If the child benefits from further assessments, good time to talk to your doctor and pursue referrals
  - Parents to sign a consent form for the district/school to connect with the professionals working with the child.
- **January-February:** kindergarten orientation meeting for parents.
  - The goal of the meeting is to introduce the family and the child to the team while giving parents an opportunity to address worries and concerns about the transition process.

# Kindergarten Transition Planning/Timeline

## Special Needs Students

- **May-June:** A member of the school district's learning services may arrange a visit with the child's current child care provider to observe and meet the child in a familiar environment
  - Transition meeting: arranged by the school or the current child care centre.
  - Main objective of this meeting is that the school team is more aware of the child's strengths, interests and needs as well as to develop recommendations about the level of support and type of support the child will need while at school.
  - School-based teams, kindergarten teacher, learning support teach and other school district support will be participating.
  - This is a great opportunity for the parents to ask their questions regarding support ( EA support, involvement, community based professionals involvement.)

# Kindergarten Transition Planning/Timeline

## Special Needs Students

- **September – October:** discharge report from other professionals will be provided to the school (i.e., SLP, OT, BC, PT)
  - All children transitioning to kindergarten have a gradual enter. This can be individualized depending on the student, in collaboration with the parents.
  - IEP meeting will be scheduled in October. School based, district based and community based professional may attend.

## HELPFUL INFORMATION ABOUT MY CHILD

1. To enhance communication with my child ...
2. To encourage my child ...
3. To prepare my child for change ...
4. To facilitate social/play and interaction with my child ...
5. To promote my child's independence in the classroom ...
6. My child's learning strengths are ...
7. My child's specific learning characteristics are ...
8. My child's gifts are ...
9. My child's learning needs are ...
10. Things to watch for regarding my child include ...
11. My child enjoys ...
12. My concerns when my child is in kindergarten are...
13. My goals for my child during kindergarten are ...

# Gradual Entry - Kindergarten

- All schools in B.C. offer gradual entry for students in Kindergarten.
- Gradual entry gives the students, teachers and parents the opportunity to learn new routines, one another and to create success for students as the transition to attending full-day Kindergarten.

# Gradual Entry – Kindergarten – Example

| Monday                                                                                       | Tuesday                                                               | Wednesday                                                                                 | Thursday                                                       | Friday                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Labour Day                                                                                   | Attendance                                                            | Interviews                                                                                | Gradual Entry                                                  | Gradual Entry                                                  |
|                                                                                              | 9:00-9:30<br>Registration<br>confirmation<br>Sign up for<br>interview | Parents only<br>orientation                                                               | Children attend<br>for one hour<br>Parent interviews           | Children attend<br>for one hour<br>Parent interviews           |
| Monday                                                                                       | Tuesday                                                               | Wednesday                                                                                 | Thursday                                                       | Friday                                                         |
| Gradual Entry                                                                                | Gradual Entry                                                         | Gradual Entry                                                                             | Shortened Day                                                  | Shortened Day                                                  |
| Children attend<br>two hours either<br>in the morning or<br>afternoon<br><br>(bring a snack) | 9:00- 11:00 am<br>Group B<br>(bring a snack)                          | 9:00-11:30<br>All students<br>attend (bring a<br>snack)<br><br>Parent<br>Interviews in pm | All students<br>attend 9:00-2:00<br>(bring a snack &<br>lunch) | All students<br>attend 9:00-2:00<br>(bring a snack &<br>lunch) |



# Typical Full Day Kindergarten



Centers/Play  
Read Aloud & Early  
Literacy Activities  
Art and Emergent  
Writing activities  
Whole group time  
Songs and games  
Oral language  
development  
Outdoor play  
Book Time



# Transition to Kindergarten – ways to support

We can ask ourselves:

- What visuals, language, and expectations can I introduce so our students have a smooth transition?
- What activities, materials, or expectations might need to be adapted for our students once they're in kindergarten?
- What self-help or functional skills do I need to work on with my students to promote independence and confidence in kindergarten?
- How can I connect with my student to create that all important relationship?
- How can I make my student feel safe?



# Transition Planning for Adulthood

- Students with certain developmental disabilities often qualify for community support services once they transition into adulthood.
- Beginning in Gr. 10, the student's case manager and family begin coordinating with these community services to plan for the student's transition out of the public school system.
- Updated cognitive/adaptive assessment *may* happen around Gr. 10.
  - EAs could be asked to complete rating scales as part of the assessment

# Helping Youth with Special Needs Transitioning to Adulthood

- Transition planning
  - process begins when the student is 14 years old.
  - Involves the student, student's family (or guardian), school-based team, local/community service providers
  - Preparing students to leave high school, find a job, find a place to live, get involved in their community and possibly continue their education.
  - Person-centred planning – encourages student & their family to actively participate,
  - IEP may be used as the Transition Plan
  - In British Columbia, the school system supports youth involvement in future life planning. School graduation requirements include the successful completion of the Grade 10 Planning course and a Graduation Portfolio.

# Six Steps to a Successful Transition Plan

1. Building Transition Planning Team – Parent(s), Guardian(s), other family members, Teachers, School Support Staff, Social workers, Student's friend(s).
2. Gather Information – Preferences, Experiences, Support Needs, Goals, Hopes, Skills, Community Connections, Health & Medical Needs.
3. Develop Transition Plan – outlining the tasks to reach the goal (identify goals, short-term & long-term)
  - i. Identify what services and supports are available (health, daily living skills, housing/living arrangement, finances & money management, friendship and socialization, transportation, post-secondary education, employment, legal & advocacy needs)
  - ii. Identify the steps that must be taken to achieve your goals (specific tasks to transition team members)

# Setting Your Goals: Examples

HEALTH :I will take my medication at the right time, without anyone reminding me to do so.)

DAILY LIVING : I will be able to plan and prepare all of my meals.

HOUSING / LIVING ARRANGEMENTS : I will live in my own apartment.

FINANCES / MONEY: I will deposit my allowance and any other money I earn into a bank account using an ATM bank machine.)

FRIENDSHIPS / SOCIAL LIFE: I will get together with my friends to socialize once a week.

TRANSPORTATION: I will take a public

POST-SECONDARY EDUCATION / TRAINING: I will go to college to become a \_\_\_\_\_.)bus to school.

LEGAL / ADVOCACY : I will learn how to advocate for myself.

# Six Steps to a Successful Transition Plan

4. Put Transition Plan into Action – (who, how, when will do what task)
5. Update Transition Plan – Keep track of progress, adjust plan if needed
6. Exit Meeting – nearing the end of high school, transition Plan finalized, tasks completed & checked off

## Team Members

|         |                                                                                      |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alex    | student                                                                              |
| Judy    | mother                                                                               |
| Charles | transition coordinator and special education teacher,<br>School to Work program      |
| George  | School to Work assistant                                                             |
| Michael | support worker for after school program<br>(family is using Autism Funding for this) |
| Mary    | Community Living Services (CLS) social worker                                        |

## Alex's Vision

Alex and his family would like a supported employment position for Alex in his neighbourhood. His family sees him living at home in the immediate future and then possibly living with another young adult with special needs in a supported placement.

## PART 1: ALEX'S EMPLOYMENT PLAN

### Employment Goal

*Short term:* Alex will participate in a variety of supported work placements over the next two years.

*Long term:* Alex will work full-time with support.

## Skills and Abilities

Currently, Alex's interests lie in using computer programs, counting money, using vending machines, organizing basic materials (sorting, distributing) and grooming and walking small dogs. He participates in a number of Life Skills Programs at school (basic literacy and numeracy and recreation and leisure programs). This term Alex has also worked at the SPCA and at his local grocery store stocking shelves.

## Tasks To Be Completed To Achieve Alex's Employment Goal

1. Alex will continue in the School to Work program for his remaining two years of high school.  
*Until June 2007.*
2. Alex will explore other work experiences based on his interests and strengths.  
*By January 2005.*
3. Alex will identify a preferred job site for his entry into supported employment.  
*By January 2007.*
4. The CLS social worker will assist Alex and his mother where needed to identify adult services and programs available through the Ministry of Human Resources, including financial assistance, transportation, employment planning and support.  
*By December 2006.*

# Transition Planning for Adulthood

- **A Navigator:** can help the student & their family to plan and provide support on student's journey to become an adult. Everyone is different, and your Navigator can help to meet individual goals and needs.
- They can help connect the student with supports from government and your community.

## Eligibility

- Have a Developmental Disability, Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) or Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD)
- Are between 16 and 24 years old
- Would like help planning for your future

# Transition Planning for Adulthood

- The navigator meets with the student and his/her family to discuss goals and dreams the student have when they get older.
- The navigator helps the student connect to the supports and services in order to reach those goals:
  - Identify your future goals
  - Talk about if you want to go to school or find a job
  - Plan where you want to live
  - Discuss hobbies and activities you want to do
  - Bring together any supports you might already have
  - Find government and community services that are right for you
  - Share your story with other people who can help



# Transition Planning for Adulthood: Community Services

**Services to Adults with Developmental Disabilities (STADD) is a partnership among;**

- Ministry of Children and Family Development (MCFD)
- Ministry of Social Development and Poverty Reduction (SDPR)
- Schools and school districts
- Delegated Aboriginal Agencies (DAAs)
- Community Living BC (CLBC)
- WorkBC Employment Service Centres
- Ministry of Advanced Education, Skills and Training (AEST)
- Health Authorities
- Public Guardian and Trustee
- Various other community organizations.

# Transition Planning: Community Services

- Community Living British Columbia (CLBC)
  - Can apply for eligibility when a student turns 16 years old
- STADD Navigator services
  - services through the transition period of 16-24 years old
  - a program that offers a Navigator service to the student and their family to help in planning and accessing services and supports as you move to adulthood
  - The STADD Navigator acts as a coordinator, making it possible for workers from different organizations to come together

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mDGOL-HiWO8&t=2s>